



Botswana



Okavango River

The Okavango is 1,050 miles (1,700 km) long and flows into the Kalahari Desert, forming a huge inland delta of marshland and floodplains. Here live some of the most endangered animals, such as rhinos and lions.

Meerkat mob

Found only in parts of Southern Africa, these small members of the mongoose family live in large colonies across Botswana's plains.



Termite mound ovens
Abandoned yet sturdy termite mounds can be used as outdoor ovens for cooking bread and meat, since they are excellent at retaining heat.

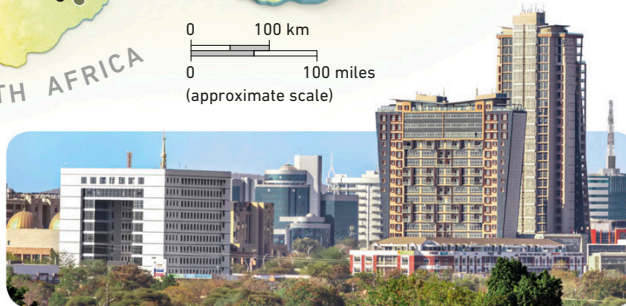


A hole is made on one side to allow excess smoke to escape.



Kalahari Desert

Kalahari sands spread across 84 percent of Botswana. This desert is the second largest in Africa, after the Sahara.



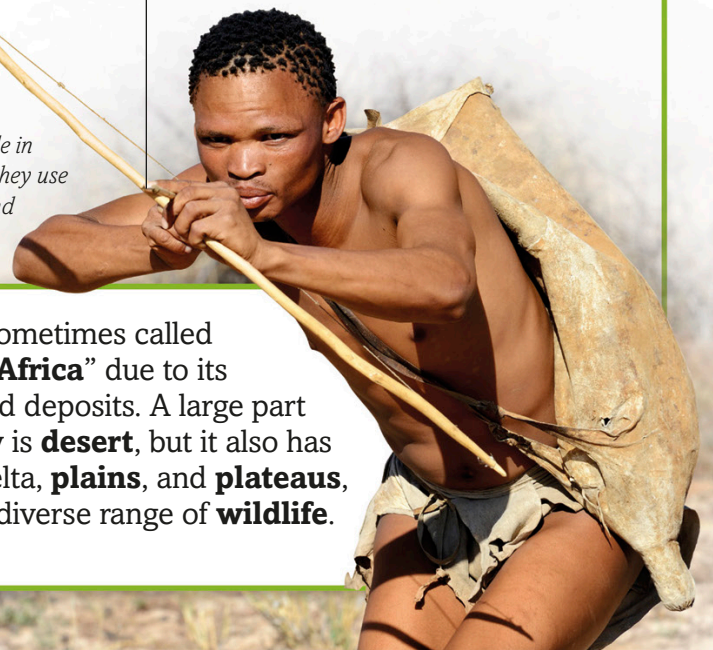
Capital city

The largest city in Botswana, Gaborone is also the center of government. As well as many cultural sites, the city has a game reserve within its limits.

San hunters use arrows dipped in a poison made from beetle larvae.

San people

For 20,000 years, these indigenous people have led a nomadic lifestyle in the Kalahari Desert, where they use their hunting, fishing, and foraging skills to survive.



- 📏 224,607 sq miles (581,730 sq km)
- 👤 2.3 million
- ★ Gaborone
- 🗣️ Setswana, English, other languages (+4)

Botswana is sometimes called the “**Gem of Africa**” due to its many diamond deposits. A large part of the country is **desert**, but it also has a lush river delta, **plains**, and **plateaus**, all home to a diverse range of **wildlife**.